

Tasin Academy

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Training the mind can get us to a place of flow more quickly. **Meditation** is one way to exercise our mental muscles.

There are many types of meditation, but they all have the same objective: calming the mind, observing our thoughts and emotions, and centering our focus on a single object.

The basic practice involves sitting with a straight back and focusing on your breath. Anyone can do it, and you feel a difference after just one session. By fixing your attention on the air moving in and out of your nose, you can slow the torrent of thoughts and clear your mental horizons.

If we want to get better at reaching a state of flow, meditation is an excellent antidote to our smartphones and their notifications constantly clamoring for our attention.

One of the most common mistakes among people starting to meditate is worrying about doing it "right." Achieving absolute mental silence, or reaching "nirvana," is not the most important thing. The most important thing is to focus on the journey.

Since the mind is a constant swirl of thoughts, ideas, and emotions, slowing down the "centrifuge"—even for just a few seconds—can help us feel more rested and leave us with a sense of clarity.

In fact, one of the things we learn in the practice of meditation is not to worry about anything that flits across our mental screen. The idea of killing our boss might flash into our mind, but we simply label it as a thought and let it pass like a cloud, without judging or rejecting it. It is only a thought—one of the sixty thousand we have every day, according to some experts.

Meditation generates alpha and theta brain waves. For those experienced in meditation, these waves appear right away, while it might take a half hour for a beginner to experience them. These relaxing brain waves are the ones that are activated right before we fall asleep, as we lie in the sun, or right after taking a hot bath.

We all carry a spa with us everywhere we go. It's just a matter of knowing how to get in—something anyone can do, with a bit of practice.

1.A. Choose the correct answer from the alternatives:

(10x0.5=5)

(a) What does the term 'constant swirl' imply about the mind?

- (i) It is peaceful. (ii) It is always calm.
- (iii) It is always active and busy. (iv) It is focused.

(b) The term 'centrifuge' in the text refers to what?

- (i) a physical device (ii) the swirling nature of thoughts
- (iii) a meditation technique (iv) a type of brain wave

(c) What is the main objective of meditation?

- (i) distracting the mind (ii) calming the mind
- (iii) overthinking emotions (iv) ignoring thoughts

(d) What is the main benefit of focusing on breath during meditation?

- (i) It enhances physical strength. (ii) It allows one to think clearly.
- (iii) It increases distractions. (iv) It makes one sleepy.

(e) What does the phrase 'letting thoughts pass like a cloud' suggest?

- (i) We should ignore our thoughts completely. (iv) Thoughts should be written down.
- (ii) We should accept and not judge our thoughts.
- (iii) Thoughts are harmful.

(f) According to the text, what is the basic practice of meditation?

- (i) lying down with eyes closed (ii) sitting with a straight back and focusing on breath
(iii) walking in nature (iv) listening to music

(g) What is one common mistake beginners make when meditating?

- (i) meditating too long (ii) worrying about doing it 'right'
(iii) focusing too much (iv) practicing with others

(h) What, as the text says, is the most important aspect of meditation?

- (i) achieving perfect silence (ii) focusing on the journey
(iii) competing with others (iv) meditating for a long time

(i) Which of the following is not a type of meditation mentioned in the text?

- (i) breathing meditation (ii) guided meditation
(iii) visualization meditation (iv) stress meditation

(j) What can help us feel more rested according to the text?

- (i) stopping all thoughts (ii) slowing down the centrifuge for a few seconds
(iii) avoiding meditation (iv) focusing on distractions

1.B. Answer the following questions:

(5x2=10)

- (a) What is the common goal of different types of meditation as described in the text?
(b) Describe the basic practice of meditation mentioned in the text.
(c) How does focusing on breath during meditation benefit the mind?
(d) In what way does meditation serve as an antidote to smartphone distractions?
(e) What common mistake do beginners often make when starting to meditate?

2. Read the passage and complete the table below with the given information.

1x10=10

Who/What	Event/Activity	What/Where	When/Why
(i).....	(ii).....	Training the mind	
(iii).....	do	meditation	(iv).....
One	(v).....	A difference	(vi)..... ..
Meditation	Is of	(vii).....	
(viii).....	have	The same objective	
People doing meditation	(ix).....	On the air moving in and out of their nose	
(x).....	Constantly clamor for	Our attention	

Or,

Read the above passage and make a flowchart showing the basic types, practices & objectives of meditation. (One is done for you.)

2x5=10

1. Exercising mental muscles	→	2	→	3	→	4	→	5	→	6
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3. Summary Writing

10

Write a summary of the passage in your own words.